METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Opportunities in Green Building Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Opportunities in Green Building Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's),[1] outputs are determined. Opportunities in Green Building is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated based on the resource consumption and carbon intensity of their property assets, their potential exposure to environmental building regulations and their efforts to improve the environmental performance of their real estate assets.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Opportunities associated with this Key Issue

- Increased access to markets created by regulatory reforms and incentives.
- Increased revenue from capturing changing tenant demand.
- Increased market share in specific market segments due to early-mover advantage.

Opportunities in Green Building Key Issue score

The Opportunities in Green Building Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, opportunities on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that the Exposure score determines the weight placed on the Management score, ranging from 50% (when the Exposure score is equal to zero) to 100% (when the Exposure score is equal to 10).

$$KI_i = \left(\left(\frac{EXP_i}{20} + 0.5\right) * MGMT_i\right) + \left(\left(0.5 - \frac{EXP_i}{20}\right) * 5\right)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Opportunities in Green Building Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Opportunities in Green Building Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the

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relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Opportunities in Green Building Practices score	Extent of green building certification commitments in portfolio or development pipeline
	Extent of commercial arrangements to improve or maintain property environmental performance
	Use of green or triple-net leases
	Green certification commitments related to greenfield developments
	Evidence of flexible or mixed-use properties in portfolio
	Evidence of urban revitalization developments
	Green building commitment extends to existing buildings in portfolio (in addition to new buildings)
Opportunities in Green Building Performance score	Green building certification
	Carbon emissions performance relative to peers

Opportunities in Green Building Management score

The Opportunities in Green Building Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Opportunities in Green Building Management score:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

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- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Opportunities in Green Building Practices score

The Opportunities in Green Building Practices score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to opportunities related to the resource consumption and carbon intensity of its property assets and its efforts to improve the environmental performance of its real estate assets. This score is a component of the Opportunities in Green Building Management score and considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Extent of green building certification commitments in portfolio or development pipeline**

Definition: The portion of the company's portfolio or development projects that are covered by its green building commitments. Applies to real estate companies only.

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- **Extent of commercial arrangements to improve or maintain property environmental performance**

Definition: Indicates whether the company provides evidence of implementing commercial agreements to incentivize tenants and property managers to improve property environmental performance. Applies to real estate companies only.

- **Use of green or triple-net leases**

Definition: Indicates whether the company provides evidence of implementing green leases or triple-net leases in its tenancies. Applies to real estate companies only.

- **Green certification commitments related to greenfield developments**

Definition: The company's green building strategy for greenfield sites, including whether there is a clear statement on avoiding greenfield sites, the company only develops green-certified properties on greenfield developments, or we found no evidence of green certification for greenfield developments. Applies to real estate companies only.

- **Evidence of flexible or mixed-use properties in portfolio**

Definition: Indicates whether the company provides evidence of flexible or mixed-use properties in its property portfolio. Applies to real estate companies only.

- **Evidence of urban revitalization developments**

Definition: The level of urban redevelopment that the company undertakes. Best practice is urban revitalization. Applies to real estate companies only.

- **Green building commitment extends to existing buildings in portfolio (in addition to new buildings)**

Definition: Indicates whether the company renovates or redevelops its existing properties with either green building initiatives or green building certifications. Applies to real estate companies only.

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Opportunities in Green Building Performance score

The Opportunities in Green Building Performance score evaluates the company's performance on opportunities in green building metrics (including percentage of green-certified buildings and space, and carbon emissions) relative to its peers. It is expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

The following provides a non-exhaustive overview of the indicators and sub-indicators used in the assessment of the Opportunities in Green Building Performance score.

- **Green building certification score**

  Definition: Assesses the extent of certified spaces or buildings under selected green building standards. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating highest level of certification coverage across the portfolio.

  - **Score of green certified buildings as % of total**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the share of green-certified buildings within its real estate portfolio, calculated as the percentage of total buildings that hold recognized green building certifications. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

  - **Score of green certified space as % of total**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the share of green-certified space within its real estate portfolio, calculated as the percentage of total floor area that holds recognized green building certifications. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

  - **Evidence of green certified buildings in real estate portfolio**

    Definition: Assesses the extent to which the company provides verifiable evidence of green-certified buildings within its real estate portfolio, based on the availability and quality of supporting documentation such as certification records or third-party registries. Expressed as a 0–5 score, where 10 indicates comprehensive and verifiable evidence.

- **Carbon emissions performance relative to peers**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on greenhouse gas [GHG] emissions intensity (normalized by sales or by units of production), and trend in GHG emissions intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

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Opportunities in Green Building Exposure score

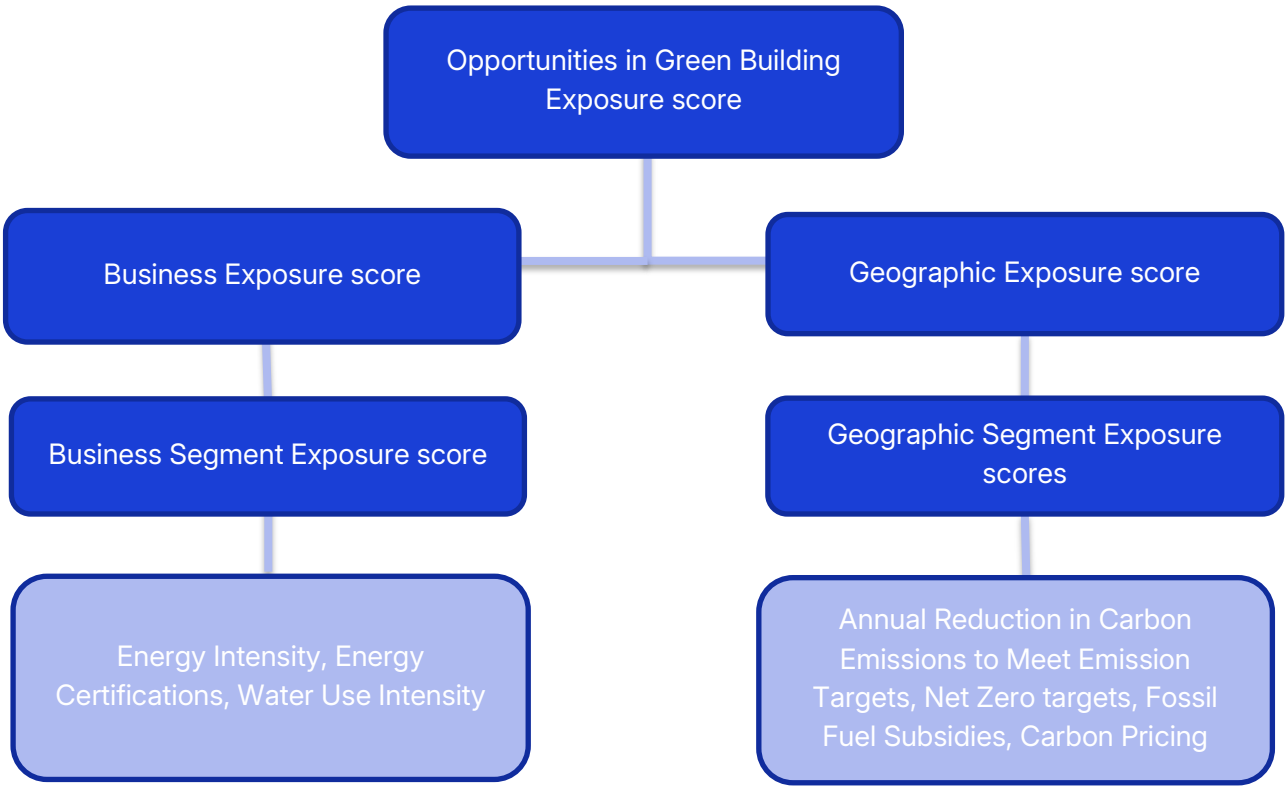
The Opportunities in Green Building Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest opportunity and 0 corresponding to the lowest opportunity. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{OGB,i} = BUS_{OGB,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{OGB,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{OGB,i}$ is the Opportunities in Green Building Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{OGB,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $GEO_{OGB,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



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Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{OGB,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{OGB,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{OGB,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure score

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a weighted average of the Energy Use Intensity score, Energy Certification score and Water Use Intensity score of the activity.

$$BSE_{OGB,j} = 0.5EC_j + 0.4EUI_j + 0.1WUI_j$$

Where:

- EC_j is the Energy Certification score for business activity j.
- EUI_j is the Energy Use Intensity score for business activity j.
- WUI_j is the Water Use Intensity score for business activity j.

The Energy Certification score for a given business activity is based on the proportion of total building area that is certified to the ENERGY STAR certification for buildings.

The Energy Use Intensity score is based on the aggregate energy use intensity for each business activity in thousands of British thermal units per square foot.

The Water Use Intensity score is based on the volume of water used for each business activity in gallons per square foot. A score of 10 indicates the highest opportunity.

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Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{OGB,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{OGB,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{OGB,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of region r.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of total revenue in region r for company i.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments disclosed as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{OGB,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{OGB,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{OGB,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

Geographic Segment Exposure scores

Countries with strengthening energy and climate change regulations influence the adoption of green buildings. Therefore, the Geographic Segment Exposure score for a country is determined by the reduction in greenhouse gas emissions required per year to meet its publicly disclosed greenhouse gas emissions targets.

$$GSE_{OGB,c} = Avg(NTA_c, LTA_c, GMM_c)$$

Where:

- NTA_c, is the near-term ambition score of country or market c.
- LTA_c is the long-term ambition score of country or market c.
- GMM_c is the government and market mechanisms score of country or market c.

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The near-term ambition of a country is assessed by considering the annual emissions reduction rate needed to meet their publicly disclosed near-term climate targets. Countries with aggressive near-term targets have high emissions reduction rates and therefore a higher policy pressure segment score.

A country or market's long-term ambition indicates the strength and credibility of its long-term climate targets such as net-zero commitments. Long term targets could signal the direction of future policy and regulatory developments, even in the near term.

The government and market mechanisms score indicates the current strength of policy and market-based mechanisms signaling a government's commitment to driving the energy transition.

This score is calculated as the average of carbon pricing score and fossil fuel subsidies score.

$$GMM_c = Avg\ (\ CPM, FFS)$$

Where

- CPM is the Carbon Pricing Mechanisms score
- FFS is the Fossil Fuel Subsidies score.

Carbon pricing mechanisms score indicates mechanisms such as carbon taxes or emissions trading systems that exert policy pressure on companies by assigning a direct cost to carbon emissions.

The fossil fuel subsidies score indicates the degree of financial support for fossil fuel consumption. Lower subsidies (higher scores) increase transition pressure by removing cost advantages, whereas high subsidies (lower scores) signal continued alignment with fossil fuel-based economic structures, thus reducing policy pressure

In the absence of evidence from data sources indicating that a country has near- or long-term emissions reduction targets or carbon pricing mechanisms in place, a score of 0 is assigned. In the absence of a country's fossil fuel subsidy information, a score of 5 is assigned.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Opportunities in Green Building Exposure score:

International Monetary Fund (IMF) Implied Mitigation Targets, Net Zero Tracker, Carbon Pricing Dashboard, IMF Fossil Fuel subsidies data; Department of Energy; ENERGY STAR Portfolio Manager, Environmental Protection Agency; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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